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HOUSE FIRE RESPONSE PLAN.

// Williams Family
// 472 Cville Drive, Charlottesville, VA, 22903

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1.0 Safe Steps House Fire Pillars



1 Remove the Decision-Making Process

When every family member knows exactly where to go and what to do, movement is immediate and controlled—even in darkness and smoke.

2 Early Detection and Immediate Action

Fire outcomes are determined by how quickly danger is detected. Early detection turns a deadly surprise into a survivable escape.

3 Smoke Management and Door Control

Smoke is the primary killer in residential fires. Closed doors slow smoke spread, preserve breathable air, and buy critical time.

4 Clear, Redundant Egress

Every room must have a primary and secondary way out. Doors, windows, ladders, and pathways are planned in advance.

5 Role-Based Movement and Accountability

Children and dependents do not self-evacuate effectively. Clear adult roles ensure fast collection, movement, and accountability.

6 Do Not Fight the Fire

Fire extinguishers are used only when conditions are safe and escape is guaranteed. If there is any doubt, evacuation takes priority over property.

7 External Rally and Accountability

Families reunite at a known, safe location outside the home. Accountability prevents dangerous reentry and gives responders accurate information. Once outside, no one goes back in.

8 Maintenance and Lifecycle Readiness

Fire safety systems degrade over time. Alarms, batteries, extinguishers, and escape tools are checked regularly. Equipment that isn't ready is treated as nonexistent.

9 After-Action Review and Incremental Improvement

Every drill or real event is an opportunity to improve. Short, honest reviews identify what worked and what failed.

10 Post-Incident Safety and Recovery

Survival does not end at the curb. Knowing how to interact with firefighters, insurance, and inspectors prevents secondary harm..

2.0 Intelligence Brief: Residential House Fire Data



Sources: NFPA, USFA, CPSC, NIST, UL FSRI, CDC, and the Code of Virginia, among other primary sources.

2.1 Fire Spread in Modern vs. Legacy Residential Structures

Time to flashover in residential rooms has fallen sharply over fifty years, driven by furnishing materials (1950s–70s: solid wood, cotton, wool. Modern: polyurethane foam, polyester, engineered lumber). Petroleum-based synthetics release energy two to five times faster than the materials they replaced.⁵

TIME TO FLASHOVER: LEGACY VS. MODERN FURNISHINGS

Minutes from ignition to flashover; same 0–30 minute scale



Flashover = point at which nearly all exposed surfaces ignite simultaneously. Source: UL FSRI natural vs. synthetic comparison, repeated 2009–2020. ⁴

DOOR CONTROL AS A SURVIVAL VARIABLE

UL FSRI testing found a single closed interior door extends an adjacent room's survivable conditions roughly fourfold versus the same room with the door open, the basis for the national "close before you doze" recommendation and this plan's door-control instructions. ⁸

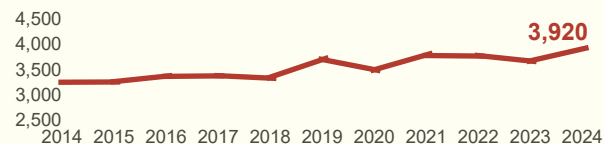
2.2 National Trends and Where Deaths Occur



Civilian fire deaths declined from 1980 through the early 2010s but have since risen, reaching 3,920 in 2024, the highest total in over a decade, driven by reduced escape times.

CIVILIAN FIRE DEATHS BY YEAR, 2014–2024

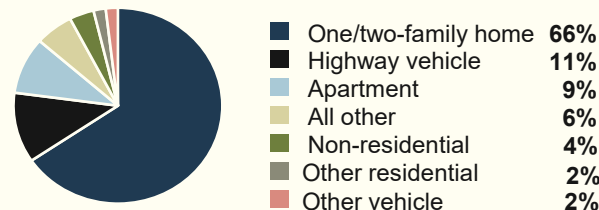
All fire types, United States · NFPA annual estimates⁹



2024 total of 3,920 is a 6.8% increase from 2023 and a 37% increase from the 2012 low of 2,855.⁹

CIVILIAN FIRE DEATHS BY OCCUPANCY TYPE, 2024

Share of all U.S. civilian fire deaths by location type¹⁰



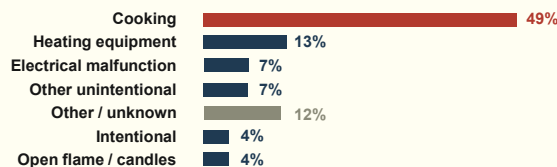
Source: NFPA Figure 9.¹⁰ One- and two-family homes = ~2/3 of all civilian fire deaths.

2.3 Leading Causes and Area of Fire Origin

Cooking dominates residential fires by frequency; heating equipment is disproportionately represented in fire deaths relative to its share of incidents. The leading area of origin also differs substantially between all fires and fatal ones.

LEADING CAUSES OF RESIDENTIAL FIRES: SHARE OF INCIDENTS

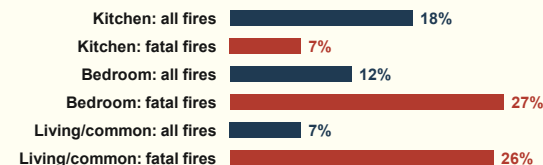
One- and two-family homes; multi-year NFPA / USFA data¹¹



Cooking fires represent nearly half of all incidents but a lower share of fire deaths, as most are detected and contained early.¹¹ Electric ranges carry a fire rate 2.6× higher than gas, an injury rate 4.8× higher, and a death rate 3.4× higher, despite only ~60% of U.S. households cooking with electricity.¹⁴

AREA OF FIRE ORIGIN: ALL FIRES VS. FATAL FIRES

navy = all fires, red = fatal fires only¹⁵

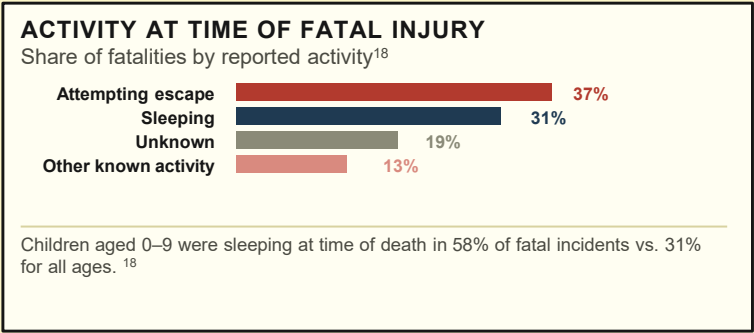
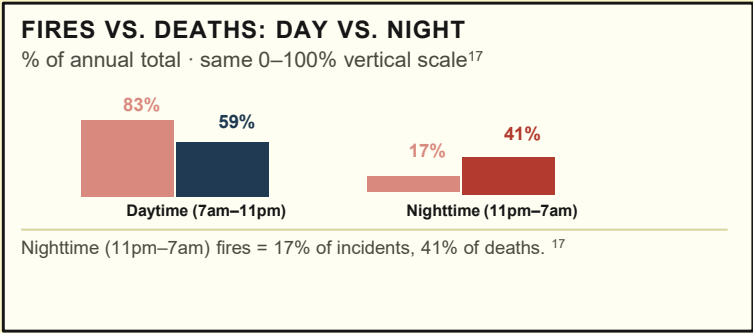


Source: USFA.¹⁵ Kitchen fires are disproportionately survivable (occupant proximity); bedroom/living-room fires are disproportionately fatal (delayed detection).

2.4 When Fires Occur and Who They Affect



Fire incidence and fire fatality follow different temporal patterns; nighttime hours produce a disproportionately high share of deaths relative to fire count.



2.5 Smoke Alarm Detection: Effectiveness and the Function Gap

Smoke alarms are associated with a significant reduction in fire death risk. Survey data shows a measurable gap between reported presence and confirmed function.

SMOKE ALARM PRESENCE VS. FUNCTIONAL STATUS	
U.S. household survey data ²⁵	
Metric	Finding
Households reporting ≥1 smoke alarm	99%
Households with alarm present but non-functional	~19%
Could correctly identify alarm's age	51%
Most common fault in non-functional alarms	Depleted battery
Home fire deaths w/o a functioning alarm	~59%

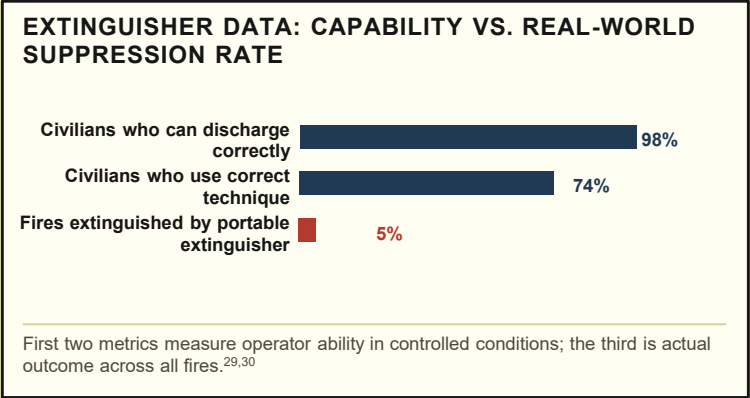
Sources: CPSC 2024 Survey²⁵

2.6

Fire Extinguisher Use: Capability vs. Real-World Outcomes



Civilian extinguisher operability is high, but successful suppression in actual residential fires is far lower, reflecting timing and fire size, not operator skill.



WHEN EXTINGUISHER USE IS LIKELY VS. UNLIKELY TO BE EFFECTIVE

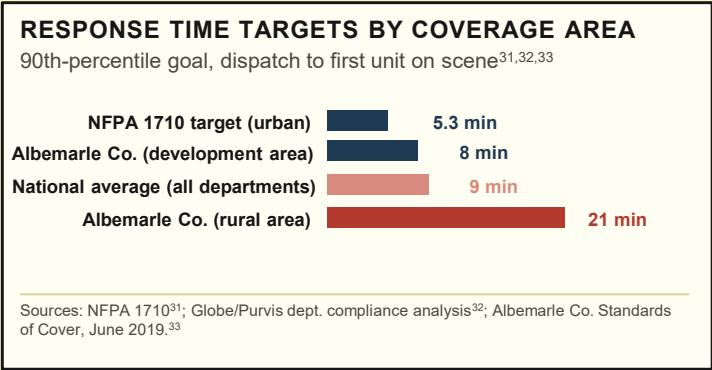
Conditions at time of fire detection

Fire Condition at Detection	Effective?
Small, contained, discovered immediately	Possible
Any doubt about fire size or spread	No, evacuate
Spread to multiple surfaces	No, evacuate
Exit route not confirmed clear	No, evacuate
Smoke filling room or hallway	No, evacuate

2.7

Fire Department Response Times

NFPA 1710 sets response-time standards for career fire departments. Compliance varies widely by jurisdiction, with rural areas facing materially longer targets than urban benchmarks.



RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN RESPONSE TIME AND OCCUPANT SURVIVAL

If a modern synthetically furnished room becomes untenable within 2–3 minutes of alarm activation, and a rural department's adopted standard targets 21 minutes, fire department response is associated with loss mitigation and containment rather than occupant survival in most such incidents. Occupant action before arrival is the primary survival mechanism in extended-response jurisdictions.

2.8 Pet Fatalities in Residential Fires



Approximately 40,000 pets die in U.S. residential fires annually, primarily from smoke inhalation³⁹; roughly 500,000 pets are affected by home fires each year in total, including injury and displacement.⁴⁰

PET BEHAVIOR DURING RESIDENTIAL FIRES	
Field observations from animal rescue organizations ⁴¹	
Behavior	Observed Pattern
Self-evacuation through open exits	Uncommon
Relocation to perceived safe location	Most common
Response to owner commands during fire	Unreliable
Typical cause of death	Smoke inhalation

2.9 Smoke Alarm Sensor Technology

Residential smoke alarms use one of two sensing principles, each tuned to a different fire type. Ionization alarms use a trace of radioactive material between charged plates to sense the tiny particles produced by fast, open-flame fires. Photoelectric alarms shine a light beam into a sensing chamber and react to the larger particles produced by slow, smoldering fires. Dual-sensor alarms combine both technologies in one housing.⁴²

STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES BY SENSOR TYPE		
Type	Best At	Weakness
Ionization	Fast-flaming fires (paper, flammable liquids)	47–53 min slower on smoldering fires; high nuisance-alarm rate near cooking
Photoelectric	Smoldering fires (overheated wiring, faulty electrical connections, smoldering embers in natural-fiber materials)	57–62 sec slower on fast-flaming fires; dust/insect sensitivity over time
Dual-sensor	Both fire types, no major documented blind spot	Higher unit cost

2.10 Detection Reliability for Children and Household Members with Hearing Loss



Sleep research at Nationwide Children's Hospital found a conventional tone alarm woke only 55–58% of children ages 5–12 within five minutes, versus 85–96% for alarms using a recorded human voice. ⁴⁶A U.K. study of 644 children ages 1–18 found 28% woke to a standard tone versus 77% to a low-frequency voice signal. ⁴⁶

ALARMS FOR SPECIAL USE CASES

Use Case	Recommendation
Children	Install voice-alert combination alarms (not tone-only) in every children's bedroom.
Mild to severe hearing loss	Low-frequency, 520 Hz audible signal in sleeping areas, substantially more effective than standard tone ⁴⁷
Moderately severe to profound hearing loss	Audible, visible (strobe), and tactile (bed shaker) together; no single device suffices alone ⁴⁷

2.11 Carbon Monoxide Detection Technology

CARBON MONOXIDE SENSOR TYPES

Type	Mechanism	Sensor Life	Notes
Electrochemical	CO reacts with an electrolyte across electrodes, generating a proportional current ⁵²	5–7 yrs	Most precise; dominant technology
Biomimetic (gel-cell)	Synthetic-hemoglobin gel darkens with cumulative exposure ⁵²	~3 yrs	Higher cost; gel degrades with age
Metal-oxide semiconductor	Heated tin-dioxide element's resistance drops in the presence of CO ⁵²	Up to 10 yrs	Continuous power draw; less precise at low ppm

UL 2034 REQUIRED ALARM WINDOWS BY CONCENTRATION

CO Concentration	Must Alarm Within	May Stay Silent Until	Physiological Effect
70 ppm	4 hrs	1 hr	50 ppm is OSHA/NIOSH occupational exposure limits
150 ppm	50 min	10 min	Headache, fatigue, nausea after 2–3 hrs
400 ppm	15 min	4 min	Frontal headache 1–2 hrs; life-threatening after 3
800ppm	15 min	4 min	Convulsions within 45 min; death within 2–3 hrs

2.12 Alarm Placement Best Practices



Smoke and CO alarms follow different placement logic: smoke rises and requires proximity to sleeping areas and stairwells; CO mixes evenly with room air.

PLACEMENT RULES: NFPA 72	
Device	Rule
Smoke alarm	Inside every bedroom; in the hallway within ~10 ft of bedroom doors; on every level including basements; ceiling-mounted preferred; ≥4 in. from corners; not within 3 ft of HVAC vents or 10 ft of a fixed cooking appliance ⁴⁴
Smoke alarm: sloped ceiling	Mount within 36 in. horizontally of the peak, but no closer than 4 in. vertically to it, where smoke can pool in dead air ⁴⁴
CO alarm	On every level including the basement; outside every sleeping area (the single most important placement); near but not immediately adjacent to fuel-burning appliances, attached garages, and fireplaces ^{44,52}
All alarms	Interconnect (hardwired or wireless) so any single alarm triggers every alarm in the home simultaneously ⁴⁴

2.13 Alarm Maintenance and Recall Verification

Test every alarm monthly; replace 9V batteries at least annually and immediately at the first low-battery chirp ; vacuum exterior vents every six months; and replace any alarm exposed to heat, smoke, or a fire event even if it still seems to work, since sensors can be damaged invisibly.

Recalls: CPSC Database

Recalls have affected units already installed and functioning normally, the defect isn't always apparent. A 2021 recall covered ~226,000 combination smoke/CO alarms found capable of delayed or failed smoke detection.⁵⁶ An earlier recall covered roughly one million CO alarms found to alarm late or not at all.⁵⁶ Check CPSC recall database.

2.14 Electrical Ignition Sources

Electrical fires frequently originate inside walls or ceilings, where they can smolder before becoming visible.⁵⁷

LEADING ITEMS FIRST IGNITED IN ELECTRICAL FIRES

Share of electrical fires by item⁵⁸



WARNING SIGNS WARRANTING AN ELECTRICIAN CALL

A persistent burning-plastic odor with no source; outlets warm to the touch; frequent breaker trips on the same circuit; flickering lights; a sizzling/buzzing sound from an outlet or panel.

2.16 Heating Ignition Sources

Most fatal heating fires start when equipment sits too close to combustible material, sometimes within inches.⁶¹ The single most effective safeguard is a three-foot clearance around any heat source.^{61,63} Space heaters should plug directly into a wall outlet, never an extension cord.⁶³

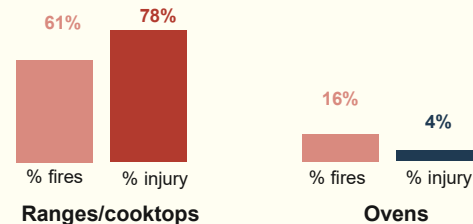
2.15 Cooking Ignition Sources

Cooking is the leading cause of home fires by a wide margin (Section 03); unattended equipment is the dominant contributing factor.¹³



COOKING FIRE RISK BY EQUIPMENT TYPE

Share of cooking fires vs. injuries¹³



CORRECT RESPONSE: GREASE FIRE

Turn off the heat source if safe to reach. Slide a metal lid or cookie sheet over the pan, never glass. Baking soda can smother a small flare-up. Never use water; never move a flaming pan.

2.18 Prevention Checklist for Single-Family Homes



Consolidated, system-by-system reference summarizing sections inspection/maintenance frequency

Action	Frequency / Trigger
Full electrical inspection	If home is 20+ years old or uninspected in the past decade
Confirm AFCI protection	Bedroom and living-area circuits, where feasible
Replace cracked, frayed, or warm cords	Immediately upon discovery
Extension cord use	Temporary only, never as permanent wiring
Maintain 3-ft clearance around every heat source	Without exception
Professional furnace & chimney inspection	Annually, before heating season
Plug space heaters directly into wall outlets	Always, never an extension cord
Turn off portable heaters	Whenever leaving the room or going to sleep
Test every smoke and CO alarm	Monthly
Replace smoke alarms	Every 10 years (Section 17)
Treat every alarm and rehearsed evacuation route as essential	Ongoing: modern furnishings compress the available escape window (Section 21)



3.0 Fire Risk & Survivability Assessment



HOUSEHOLD RISK RATING

High

Set by the household's most vulnerable occupant, not an average across the family

RESPONSE GAP

9 min

Likely first-due response (12 min) exceeds this home's ~2–3 min survivable window (Section 1)

HIGHEST-RISK OCCUPANT

Age 4

Cannot self-evacuate; cannot use available window egress; sleeps beyond open stairwell

FIRE DETECTION STATUS

Insufficient

Tone-only alarm, no voice alert, in the age-4 bedroom (Section 2)

3.1 Fire Department Response Time

Department	Coverage	Distance	Est. Response	Notes
Charlottesville Fire Department 203 Ridge St, Charlottesville, VA	Career In town	4.7 mi	14 min ~1 min dispatch + ~2 min turnout + 9 min drive	Closest career department; likely first-due response
Charlottesville-Albemarle Rescue Squad 828 McIntire Rd · Albemarle Co. Fire & Rescue	Volunteer In town	3.8 mi	16 min ~1 dispatch + ~2 turnout + ~5 call-out + 12 drive	Volunteer call-out adds meaningful delay vs. a career department
Seminole Trail Volunteer Fire Department 3055 Berkmar Dr, Charlottesville, VA	Volunteer Out of town	0.9 mi	20 min ~1 dispatch + ~2 turnout + ~5 call-out + 3 drive	Outside municipality: may respond as mutual aid; actual response time could vary



This home's survivable window (~2–3 min, Section 5)



Outside municipality: mutual aid, actual time may vary

PROPERTY ACCESS NOTES

Category	Detail
Address number visibility	Located next to door, easily visible during daytime conditions. Not visible at night unless porch light is on. Street mailbox with house number
Apparatus access	Rear of property backs to dense woods with no vehicle access; apparatus approach is limited to the front and sides only

3.1 Detection & Alert

Location	Floor	Alarm Type	Interconnected	Voice/Tone	Confirmed Functional
Living Room	1	Ionization	Yes	Tone	Yes, tested Mar 2026
Kitchen	1	Photoelectric	Yes	Tone	Yes, tested Mar 2026
Primary Bedroom	1	Dual-sensor (photo + ion)	Yes	Tone	Yes, tested Mar 2026
Garage	1	Ionization	Yes	Tone	Yes, tested Mar 2026
Study	1	Ionization	Yes	Tone	No confirmed test
Bedroom 2	2	Photoelectric	Yes	Tone	No confirmed test
Bedroom 3	2	Photoelectric	Yes	Tone	No confirmed test
Bedroom 4	2	Electrochemical CO alarm	No	Tone	No confirmed test
Multi-Purpose Room	B	Ionization	No	Tone	No confirmed test
Bedroom 5	B	Ionization	No	Tone	No confirmed test

Occupant Capability						
Occupant	Self-Rescue Capability	Alarm-Wake Reliability	Medical Notes	Window & Ladder Egress		
Dad, 40	Independent	Reliable	None noted	Capable alone		
Mom, 39	Independent	Reliable	None noted	Capable alone		
Child, age 11	Needs direction	Could sleep through tritone alarm	None noted	Possible but not likely		
Child, age 8	Needs direction	Could sleep through tritone alarm	asthma	Not viable alone		
Child, age 4	Cannot self-evacuate	Could sleep through tritone alarm	None noted	Not viable alone		
HOUSEHOLD OCCUPANCY PATTERN						
Occupant	Weekday Daytime	Weekday Overnight	Weekend Daytime	Weekend Overnight	Bedroom	Sleep Habit
Dad, 40	At work	Home	Home	Home	1 st floor	None noted
Mom, 39	Works from home	Home	Home	Home	1 st floor	White noise machine
Child, age 11	At school	Home	Home, occasional sports	Home	2 nd floor	Headphones, Bluetooth, low volume
Child, age 8	At school	Home	Home, occasional sports	Home	2 nd floor	White noise machine
Child, age 5	Home with Mom	Home	Home	Home	2 nd floor	Nightlight; occasionally sleeps in parents' room
PETS						
Name, Breed	Sleep Location	Hiding Spot	Personality			Weight
Oliver, Golden Retriever	Primary bedroom, foot of bed	Bathroom 2	Friendly, approaches strangers, will follow family members out, does not always follow commands			80 lbs
Whiskers, house cat	Varies, often 2nd-floor hallway	Under living room couch	Skittish, hides during loud noise or commotion			9 lbs

SURROUNDING AREA	
Neighbors	Both sides and across the street; none to the rear. Closest neighbor 40m door-to-door.
Line of sight	Limited visibility to left/right neighbors; substantial visibility across the street
Vegetation	Dense woodlands to the rear; interspersed trees on the property; light vegetation between neighbors; passable, not a barrier
Terrain	Flat, well-manicured, no obstacles
PERIMETER ACCESS	
Fencing	None
Foot travel	No landscaping features restrict travel
Rear access	Backs to dense woods, no vehicle access, back door to porch and side door to deck
Water supply	Roughly 40m from fire hydrant located in front of 456 Cville Drive
CONSTRUCTION	
Structure	Wood-frame construction; faster fire spread and earlier structural failure than masonry/steel
Exterior siding	Vinyl siding, higher ignition point than wood
Insulation	Fiberglass batt; dense, toxic smoke develops quickly
Roof	Asphalt shingle over plywood; rapid attic fire spread once involved
Stairwell	Open interior stairwell; smoke rises fast to 2nd-floor bedrooms
Heating	Natural gas
Survivable window	~2–3 minutes from alarm activation
EGRESS POINTS	
Doors	5 total: 2 inward-opening wood, 1 accordion glass to deck, 1 garage, 2 to 2 nd floor balconies
Ground-floor windows	8 accessible: vertical-opening, plastic locks, ~1/4" glass, all screened
2nd-floor windows	6 accessible; 4 exit to a 12-ft sub-roof level
Basement	3 egress windows across 2 rooms, 4 rooms with no egress window
Attached garage	Fire rated door separating house and garage

HOUSEHOLD RISK RATING

High

This household's composite risk rating is High. This classification reflects the convergence of five factors established across this assessment, rather than a single deficiency. First, the estimated fire department response time for this property ranges from 11 to 20 minutes (Section 1), against a structurally determined survivable window of approximately 2–3 minutes (Section 5); self-rescue therefore constitutes the household's primary survival mechanism, not external response. Second, detection reliability remains incompletely established: one bedroom is served by a tone-only alarm with no voice-alert capability, and two additional rooms have unconfirmed alarm function (Section 2). Third, household composition includes one occupant, the age-4 child, who cannot self-evacuate and has no viable secondary means of egress (Section 3). Fourth, sleeping arrangements place three of five occupants on the second floor beyond an open stairwell, with one child's sleep habit further reducing alarm-wake reliability for that occupant (Section 4). Fifth, the property's ignition profile identifies heating equipment and bedding or furniture, both associated with unattended, nighttime origin, as the highest-priority sources given this home's systems and layout (Section 6). Household risk is set by the combined effect of these factors and by the household's most vulnerable occupant, not by an average across the family.

MOST LIKELY HOUSE FIRE

The most probable fire event for this property is a cooking-related ignition occurring during daytime hours. An adult occupant is typically present in the home on weekdays (Section 3), and cooking-related fires are characterized nationally by high frequency but comparatively low severity, owing to the likelihood of prompt occupant intervention (Section 6). This scenario is expected to result in early detection and limited consequence.

MOST DEADLY HOUSE FIRE

The most severe plausible fire event for this property involves ignition originating in heating equipment or bedding/furniture, occurring overnight while all occupants are asleep (Sections 5–6). Under this scenario, the age-4 child, positioned furthest from the stairwell, without viable secondary egress, and served by a tone-only alarm (Sections 2–4), is dependent on assisted evacuation within the home's approximate 2–3 minute survivable window, a period substantially shorter than the estimated 11–20 minute fire department response time (Section 1). This scenario forms the primary basis for the household's High risk classification.

4.0 FIRE MOVEMENT AND SURVIVAL PRINCIPLES



1 Crawl Low Under Smoke

Smoke and toxic gases rise first; breathable air is lowest near the floor. Stay as low as possible when moving through smoke-filled areas to maintain access to breathable air.

2 Check Doors Before Opening

Use the back of your hand to check doors for heat before opening. Never open a hot door—find an alternate route.

3 Close Doors Behind You

Every closed door between you and the fire buys critical time for escape.

4 Maintain Wall Contact

In zero-visibility conditions, maintain physical contact with walls or baseboards to navigate.

5 Do Not Open Windows

Do not open windows unless using them to escape. Opening windows can introduce oxygen that accelerates fire growth and changes fire behavior unpredictably throughout the structure.

6 Use the Nearest Safe Exit

Use the nearest safe exit, not the familiar one. Fire blocks paths unpredictably—conditions dictate movement, not habit.

7 Seal the Room If Trapped

If escape routes are blocked, close the door, block gaps with towels or clothing, and signal visibly for rescue. A sealed room buys critical survival time.

8 Keep Doors Closed While Sleeping

Closed doors dramatically reduce smoke and heat exposure during nighttime fires. A closed bedroom door can be the difference between waking to an alarm and being overcome by smoke.

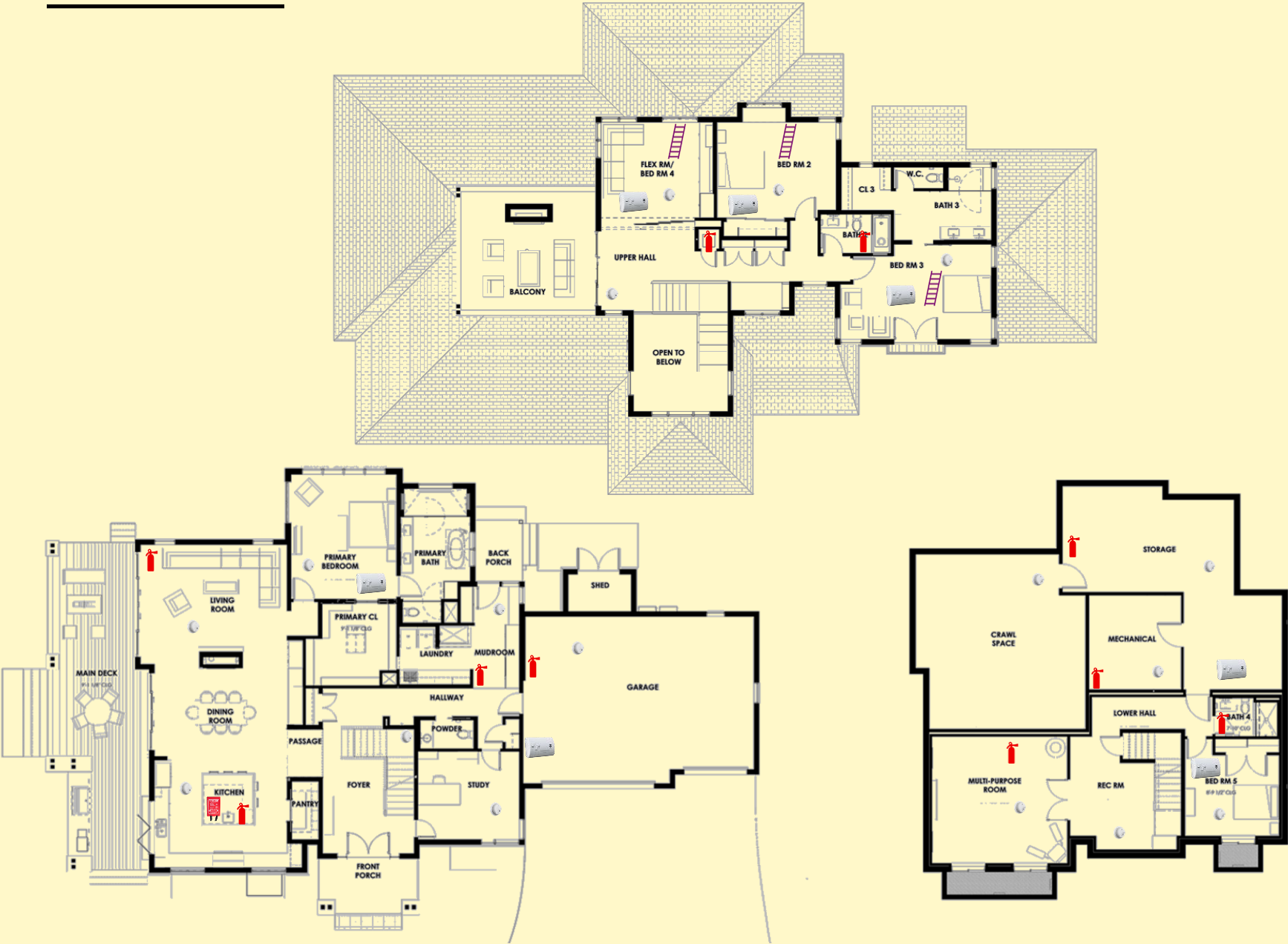
9 Shut Off HVAC If Accessible

Running HVAC systems can spread smoke rapidly through the entire home via ductwork. Shut off systems only if immediately accessible—do not delay evacuation to reach controls.

10 Signal from Windows

Firefighters locate victims faster through visible, repeated signals. Use light, movement, or bright fabric from windows to attract attention and communicate *your* location.

5.0 Floor Plan



6.0 Yellow Brick Road



Task: Ensure accountability while exiting as quickly as possible

Condition: Smoke/flame not blocking movement

Standard: Evacuated in 90 sec, 911 within 3 min

Trigger: Anyone sees smoke or flame



FIRE ESCAPE PLAN | YELLOW BRICK ROAD

SCENARIO: SMOKE/FIRE NOT BLOCKING MOVEMENT

ACTION	DAD	MOM	AGE 11	AGE 8	AGE 5
STEP 1 Alert					
STEP 2 Assess					
STEP 3 Accountability					
STEP 4 Movement					
STEP 5 Rally Point					
STEP 6 First Responder					

REVIEW THIS PLAN WITH ALL FAMILY MEMBERS • PRACTICE REGULARLY • KEEP IN AN EASILY ACCESSIBLE LOCATION

6.0.1 Yellow Brick Road



Task: Ensure accountability while exiting as quickly as possible

Condition: Smoke/flame not blocking movement

Standard: Evacuated in 90 sec, 911 within 3 min

Trigger: Anyone sees smoke or flame



FIRE ESCAPE PLAN | YELLOW BRICK ROAD

SCENARIO: SMOKE/FIRE NOT BLOCKING MOVEMENT

ACTION	DAD	MOM	AGE 11	AGE 8	AGE 5
STEP 1 Alert	Yell "Yellow Brick Road!"	Yell "Yellow Brick Road!"	Yell "Yellow Brick Road!"	Yell "Yellow Brick Road!"	Yell "Yellow Brick Road!"
STEP 2 Assess	Can it be fought safely with an extinguisher or fire blanket? If yes → fight it. Any doubt → go to Step 3.	Can it be fought safely with an extinguisher or fire blanket? If yes → fight it. Any doubt → go to Step 3.	Go to the nearest green dot on your floor. Wait there.	Go to the nearest green dot on your floor. Wait there.	Go to the nearest green dot on your floor. Wait there.
STEP 3 Accountability	Run the Yellow Brick Road. At each green dot, confirm the child. Direct them to the nearest exit or take them with you along the route and keep moving.	Go to a green dot. Call 911.	Follow Dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to neighbor's mailbox.	Follow Dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to the neighbor's mailbox.	Follow Dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to the neighbor's mailbox.
STEP 4 Movement	Exit through the nearest door on the route. (Front door or workshop back door.)	Exit through your nearest door. Go to the mailbox.	Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Go to the mailbox.	Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Go to the mailbox.	Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Go to the mailbox.
STEP 5 Rally Point	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.
STEP 6 First Responder	Call 911 if not already called. Hand emergency response sheet to firefighters.	Call 911 if not already called. Hand emergency response sheet to firefighters.			

REVIEW THIS PLAN WITH ALL FAMILY MEMBERS • PRACTICE REGULARLY • KEEP IN AN EASILY ACCESSIBLE LOCATION

STEP
1

ALERT

Alert all occupants as quickly as possible that a plan will be executed

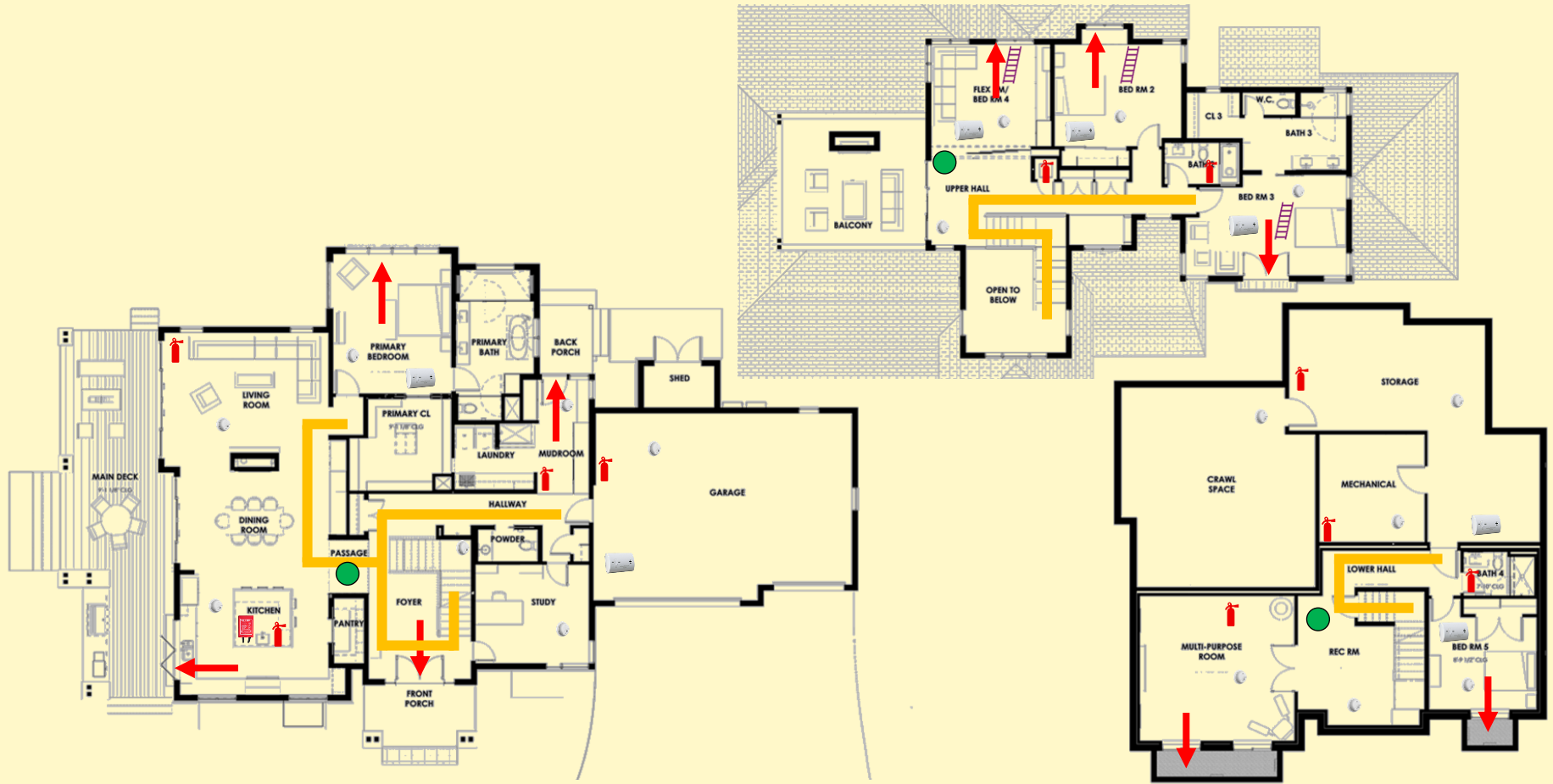
Dad Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Mom Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 11 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 9 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 6 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

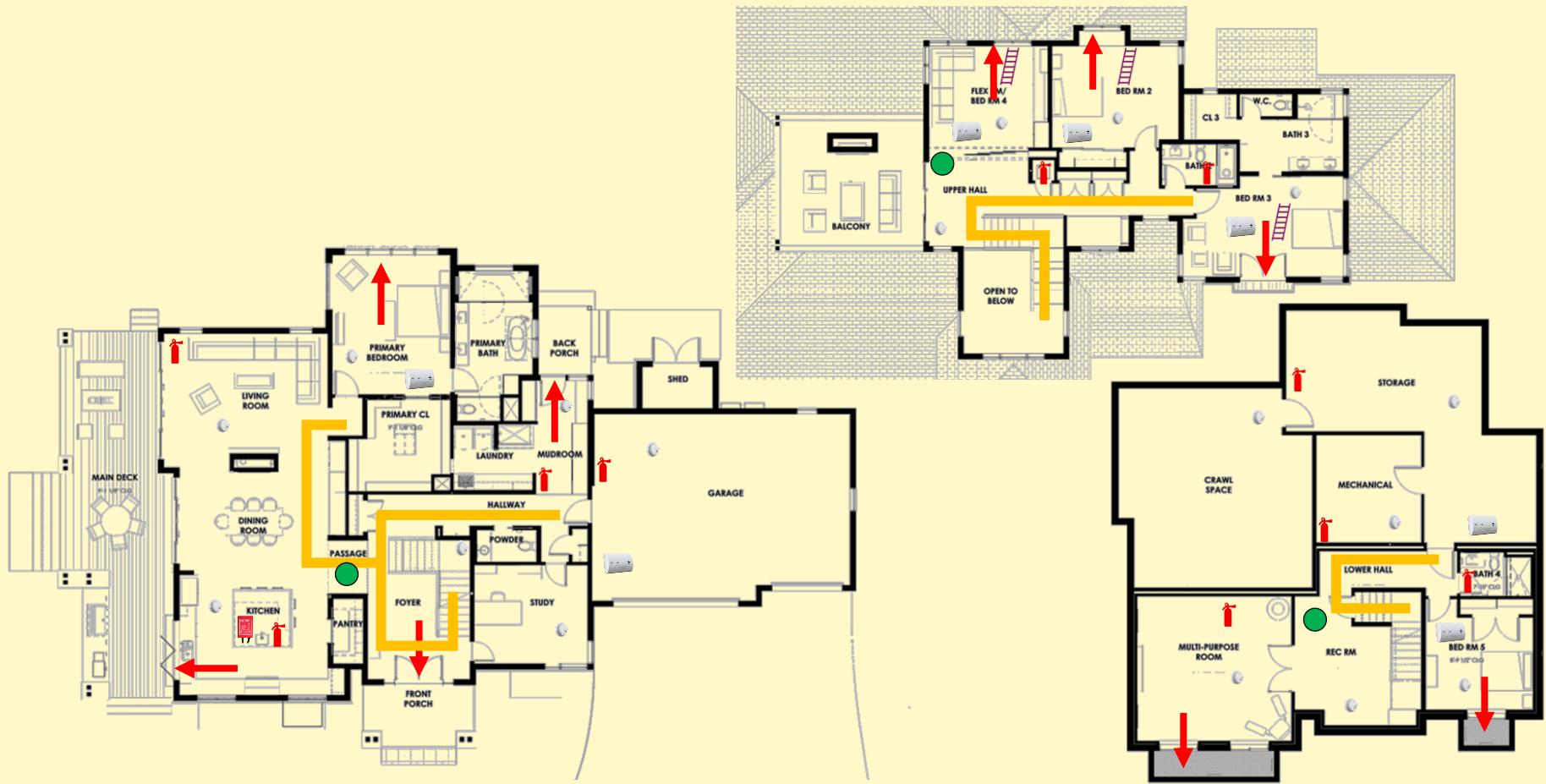


**STEP
2**

ASSESS

Adults determine if the fire can be fought and children move to internal rally points (green dots)

Dad	Can the fire be fought safely with an extinguisher or fire blanket? If yes fight it. Any doubt—go to Step 3.
Mom	Can the fire be fought safely with an extinguisher or fire blanket? If yes fight it. Any doubt—go to Step 3.
Age 11	Go to the nearest green dot on the level you are currently on. Wait there.
Age 9	Go to the nearest green dot on the level you are currently on. Wait there.
Age 6	Go to the nearest green dot on the level you are currently on. Wait there.

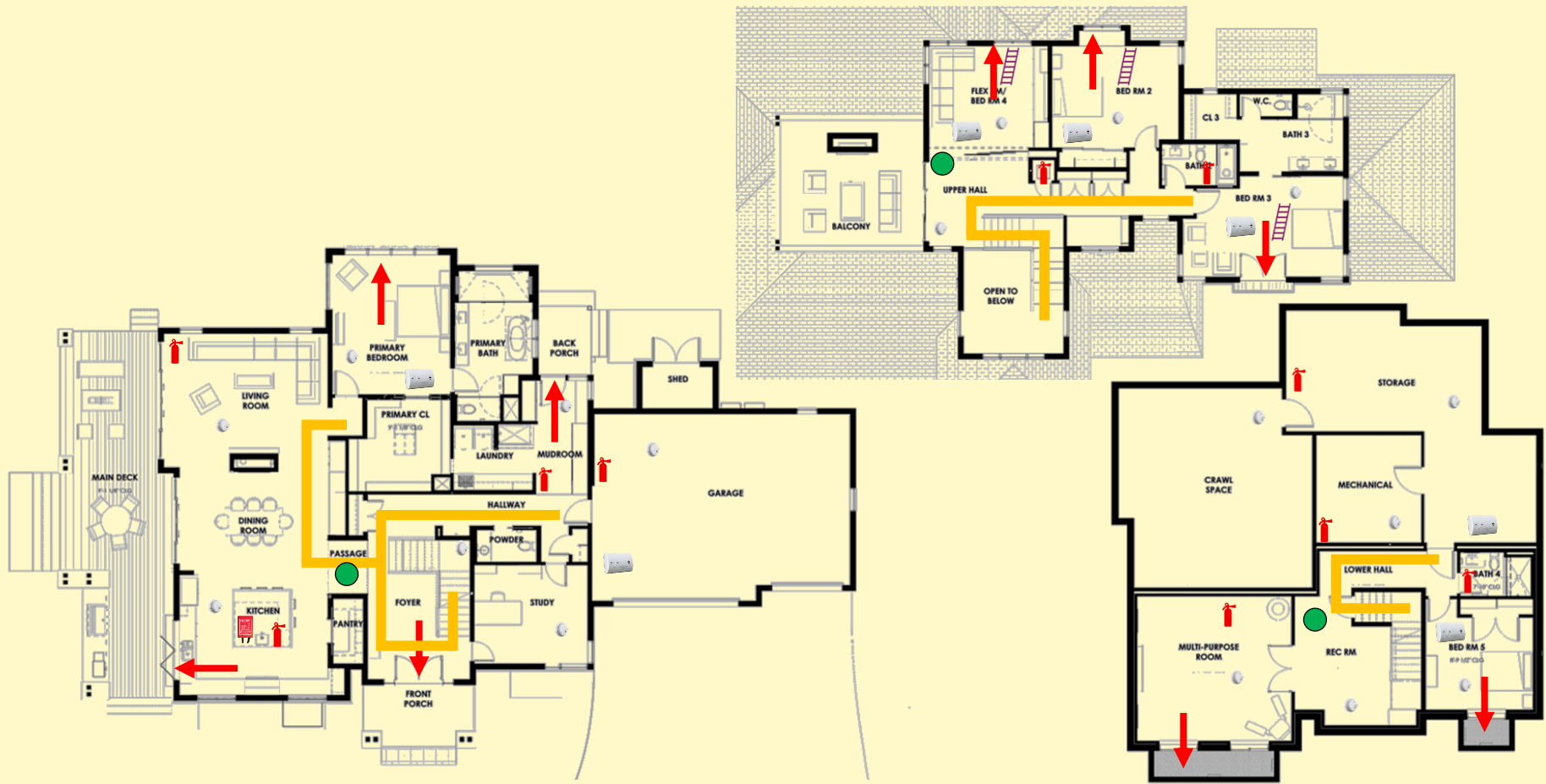


**STEP
3**

ACCOUNTABILITY

Confirm internal accountability so no one stays inside looking for someone already out. Alert first responders.

Dad	Run the Yellow Brick Road. At each green dot, confirm who's there. Direct to nearest exit or take them with you.
Mom	Go to a green dot. Call 911. Follow dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.
Age 11	Follow dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.
Age 9	Follow dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.
Age 6	Follow dad. Go to whichever exit he directs you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.



**STEP
4**

MOVEMENT

Exit the house in an orderly fashion based on Dad's instructions.

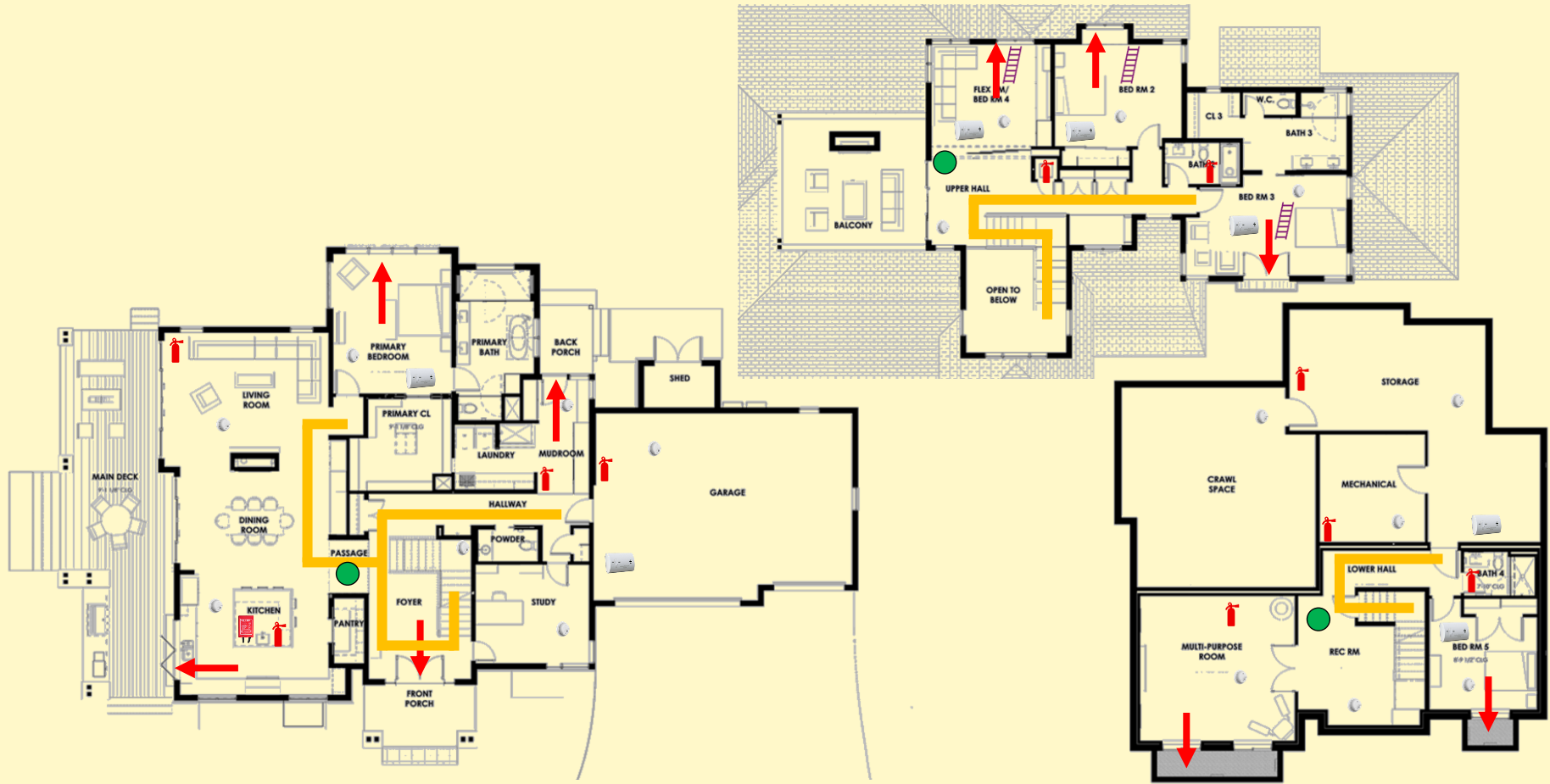
Dad Exit through the nearest door along the Yellow Brick Road: front door or workshop back door.

Mom Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.

Age 11 Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.

Age 9 Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.

Age 6 Exit through the door Dad directed you to. Head straight to 2324 mailbox.

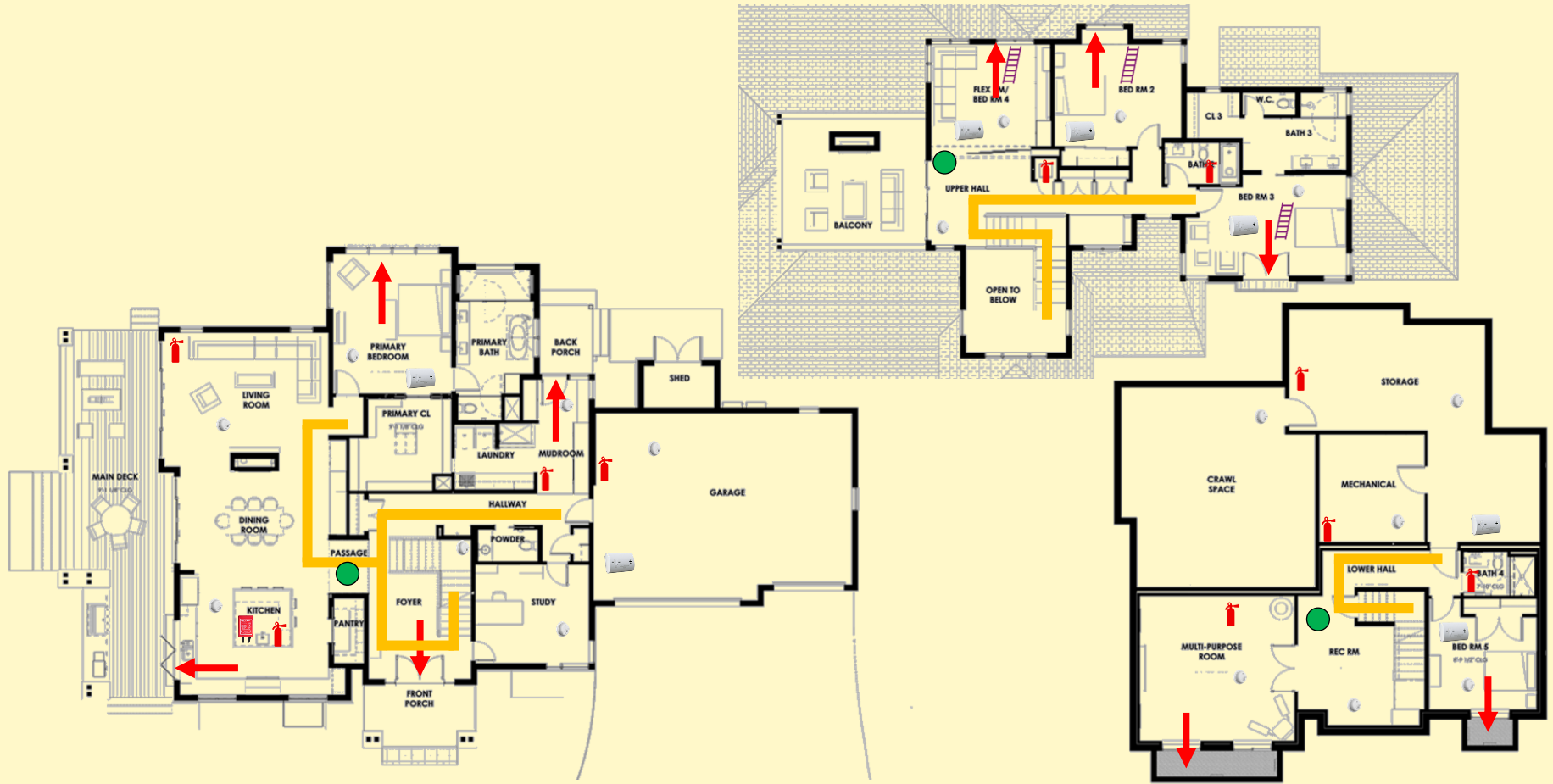


STEP
5

RALLY POINT

Establish external accountability

Dad	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.
Mom	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.
Age 11	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.
Age 9	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.
Age 6	Meet at the mailbox. No one goes back inside.



STEP
6

FIRST RESPONDER

If unable to call 911 in step 3, now you call. Prepare emergency response sheet for fire fighters.

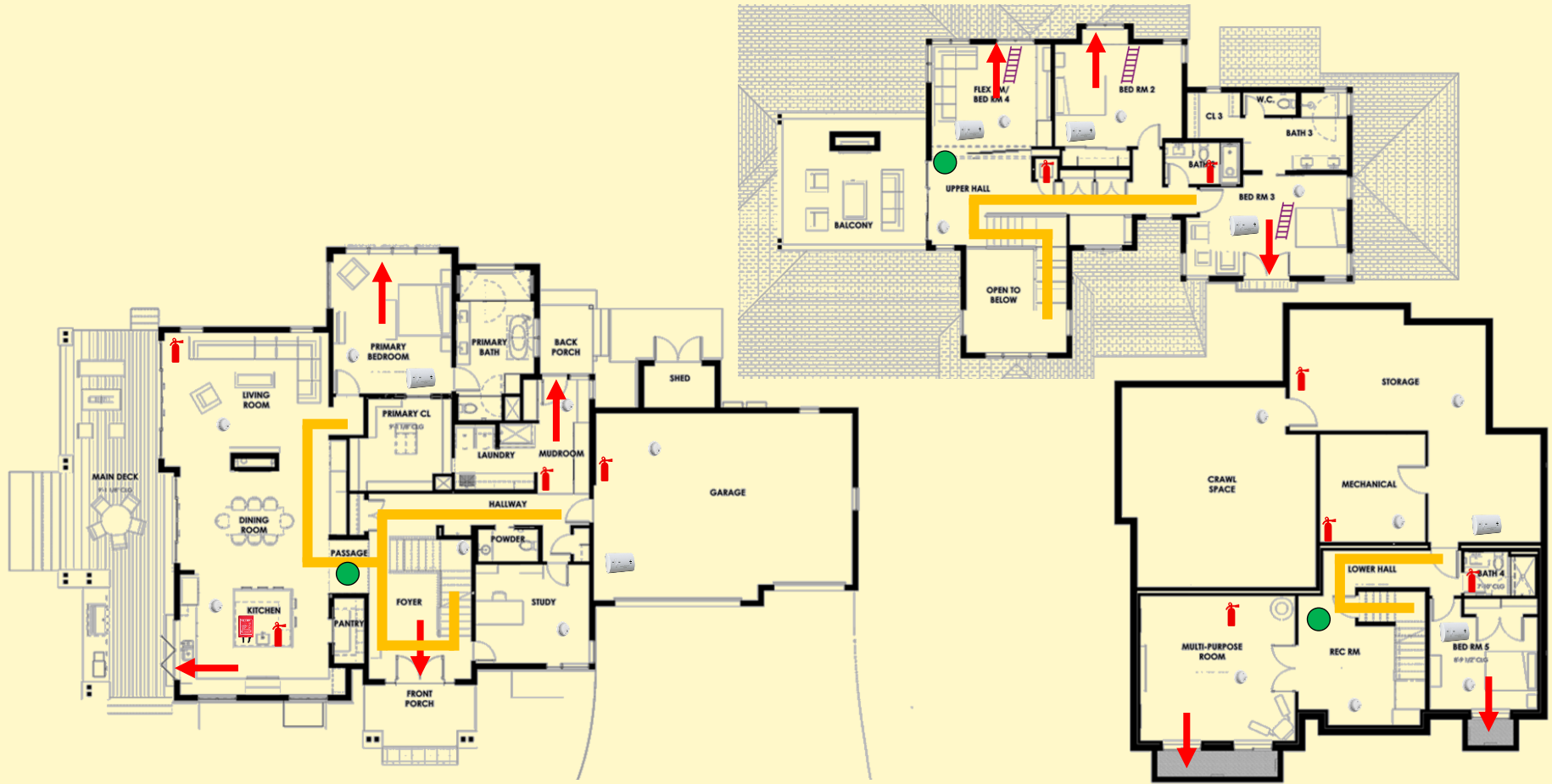
Dad Call 911 if not already called. Hand emergency response sheet to firefighters.

Mom Call 911 if not already called. Hand emergency response sheet to firefighters.

Age 11 —

Age 9 —

Age 6 —



Condition: Used when smoke or fire is blocking exits or movement through the home

Trigger: Anyone sees smoke or flame blocking movement, or hears “Alamo”

SAFE STEPS FIRE ESCAPE PLAN ALAMO															SCENARIO: SMOKE/FIRE BLOCKING MOVEMENT		
ACTION	DAD			MOM			AGE 11			AGE 8			AGE 5				
STEP 1 Alert																	
STEP 2 Assess																	
	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER		
STEP 3 Movement		YOUR ROOM	YOUR ROOM		YOUR ROOM	YOUR ROOM			YOUR ROOM			YOUR ROOM			YOUR ROOM		
STEP 4 Shelter																	
STEP 5 Rally Point																	
STEP 6 First Responder																	
REVIEW THIS PLAN WITH ALL FAMILY MEMBERS • PRACTICE REGULARLY • KEEP IN AN EASILY ACCESSIBLE LOCATION																	

Task: Exit if possible. Collapse to designated shelter location if possible. Shelter in place. Signal to first responders

Condition: Used when smoke or fire is blocking exits or movement through the home

Standard: All occupants sheltered or evacuated within 60 seconds of alert; first responders called within 3 minutes

Trigger: Anyone sees smoke or flame blocking movement, or hears "Alamo"



FIRE ESCAPE PLAN | ALAMO

SCENARIO: SMOKE/FIRE BLOCKING MOVEMENT

ACTION	DAD			MOM			AGE 11			AGE 8			AGE 5		
STEP 1 Alert	Yell "Alamo!"			Yell "Alamo!"			Yell "Alamo!"			Yell "Alamo!"			Yell "Alamo!"		
STEP 2 Assess	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke at the bottom. Heat or smoke → shelter. Neither → proceed to Step 3 Exit.			Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke at the bottom. Heat or smoke → shelter. Neither → proceed to Step 3 Exit.			Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke at the bottom. Heat or smoke → shelter. Neither → proceed to Step 3 Exit.			Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke at the bottom. Heat or smoke → shelter. Neither → proceed to Step 3 Exit.			Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke at the bottom. Heat or smoke → shelter. Neither → proceed to Step 3 Exit.		
	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER	EXIT	COLLAPSE	SHELTER
STEP 3 Movement	Exit via the closest exit. Go to the mailbox.	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Exit via the closest exit. Go to the mailbox.	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Exit via the closest exit. Go to the mailbox.	Go to Lucas's room	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Exit via the closest exit. Go to the mailbox.	Go to Lucas's room	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.	Exit via the closest exit. Go to the mailbox.	Go to Lucas's room	Stay in your room. Go to Step 4.
STEP 4 Shelter		1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.	1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.		1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.	1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.		1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.	1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.		1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.	1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.		1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.	1. Shut door. 2. Open window. 3. Grab whistle. 4. 1 green dot per person on window.
STEP 5 Rally Point	Go to mailbox. Walk the perimeter. Note all glowing green dots. Report to firefighters.			Go to mailbox. Walk the perimeter. Note all glowing green dots. Report to firefighters.			Go to mailbox. Walk the perimeter. Note all glowing green dots. Report to firefighters.			Go to mailbox. Walk the perimeter. Note all glowing green dots. Report to firefighters.			Go to mailbox. Walk the perimeter. Note all glowing green dots. Report to firefighters.		
STEP 6 First Responder	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations. Use external ladder if available.			Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations. Use external ladder if available.			Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.			Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.			Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.		

REVIEW THIS PLAN WITH ALL FAMILY MEMBERS • PRACTICE REGULARLY • KEEP IN AN EASILY ACCESSIBLE LOCATION

**STEP
1****ALERT**

Alert all occupants that exits may be blocked and the Alamo plan will be executed

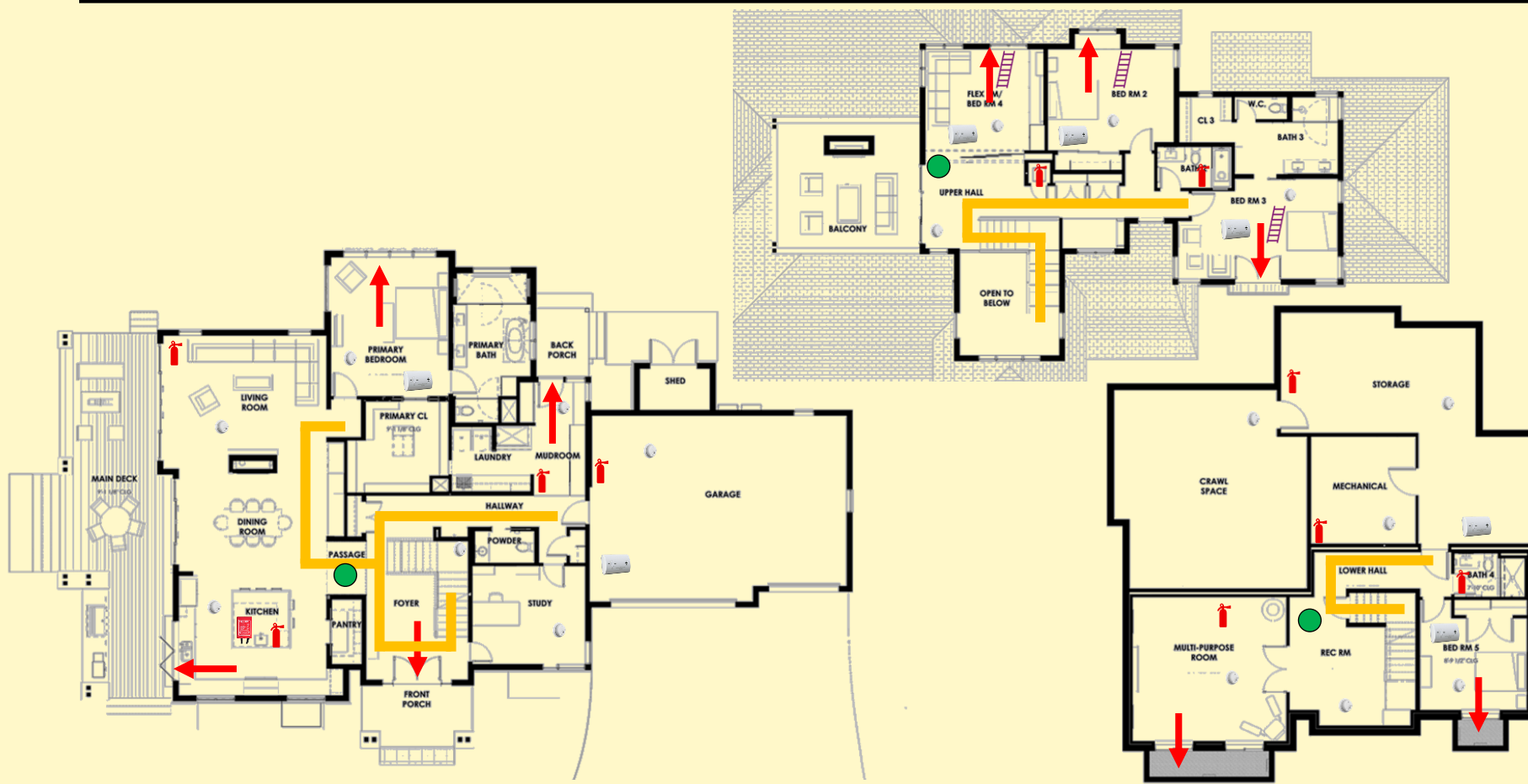
Dad Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Mom Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 11 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 9 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

Age 6 Yell "Yellow Brick Road"

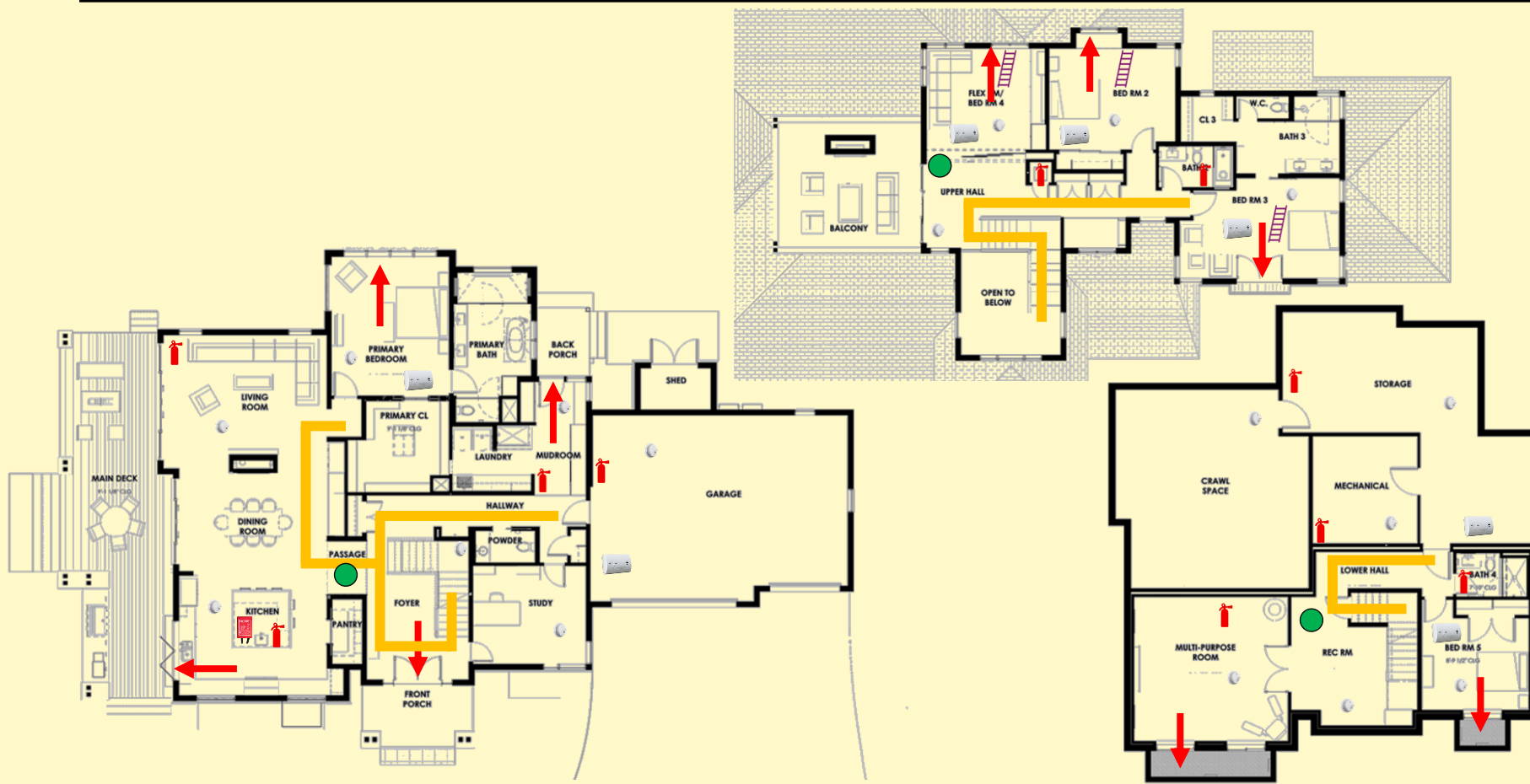


**STEP
2**

Assess

Each occupant checks their door before moving. This determines which branch to take in step 3.

Dad	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke along door seam. If heat or smoke, shelter. If neither, exit.
Mom	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke along door seam. If heat or smoke, shelter. If neither, exit.
Age 11	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke along door seam. If heat or smoke, shelter. If neither, exit.
Age 9	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke along door seam. If heat or smoke, shelter. If neither, exit.
Age 6	Feel door with back of hand. Check for smoke along door seam. If heat or smoke, shelter. If neither, exit.



STEP
3A

Movement (Exit)

Door check reveals no heat or smoke. All occupants exit through their designated primary route.

Dad	Exit via closest exit. Go directly to 242 mailbox
Mom	Exit via closest exit. Go directly to 242 mailbox
Age 11	Exit via closest exit. Go directly to 242 mailbox
Age 9	Exit via closest exit. Go directly to 242 mailbox
Age 6	Exit via closest exit. Go directly to 242 mailbox

STEP
3B

Movement (Collapse)

Hallway passable but primary exit blocked. Occupants collapse to a single room to exit together.

Dad	Stay in your room.
Mom	Stay in your room.
Age 11	Go to Lucas's room.
Age 9	Go to Lucas's room.
Age 6	Stay in your room.

**STEP
3C**

Movement (Shelter)

Heat or smoke detected at door. Cannot exit safely. Each occupant shelters in their current room.

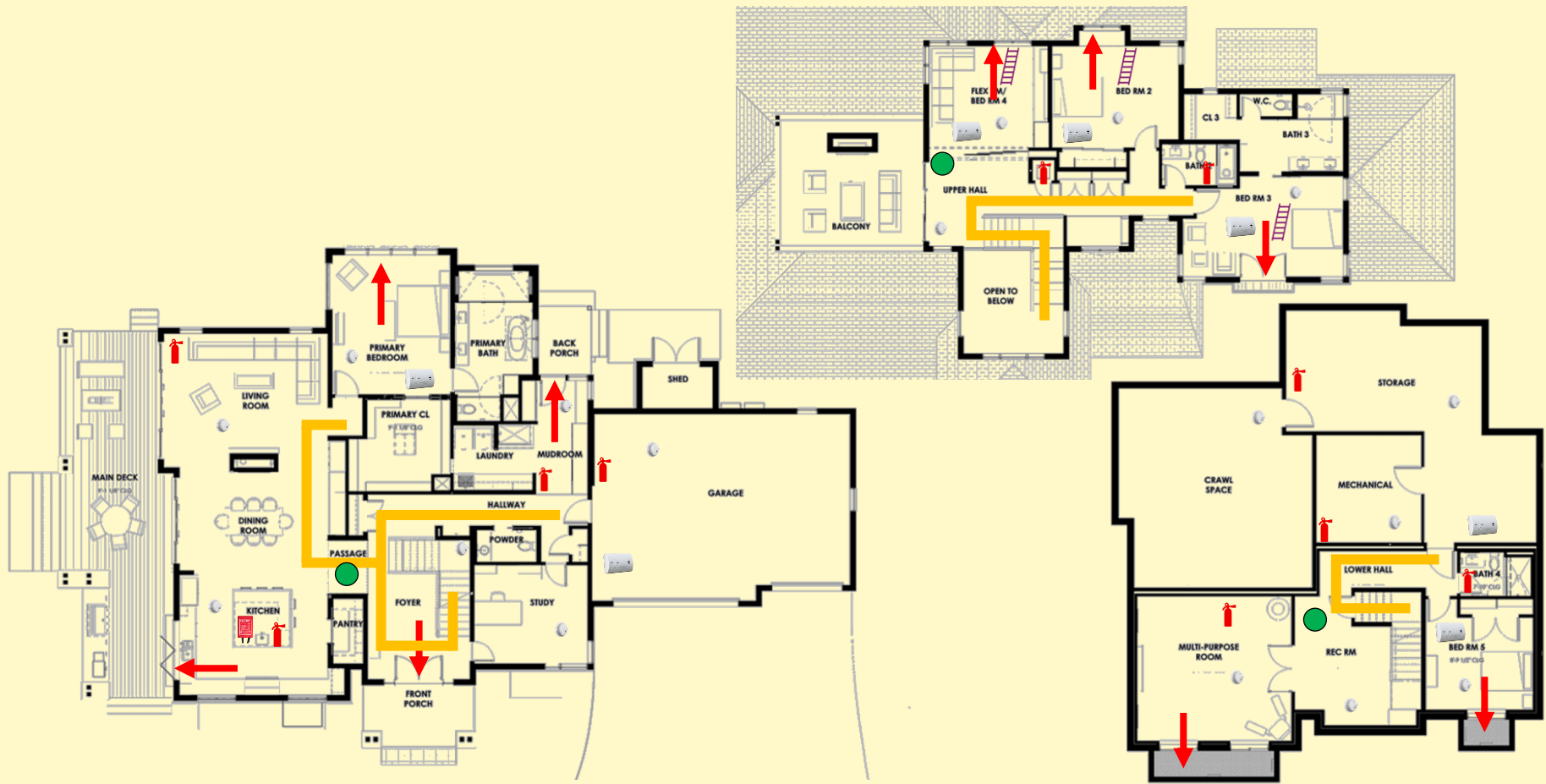
Dad Stay in your room.

Mom Stay in your room.

Age 11 Stay in your room.

Age 9 Stay in your room.

Age 6 Stay in your room.



STEP
4A

Shelter (Exit)

Ensure survivability for time it takes first responders to arrive and signal location for quick extraction.

Dad	N/A
Mom	N/A
Age 11	N/A
Age 9	N/A
Age 6	N/A

STEP
4B

Shelter (Collapse)

Ensure survivability for time it takes first responders to arrive and signal location for quick extraction.

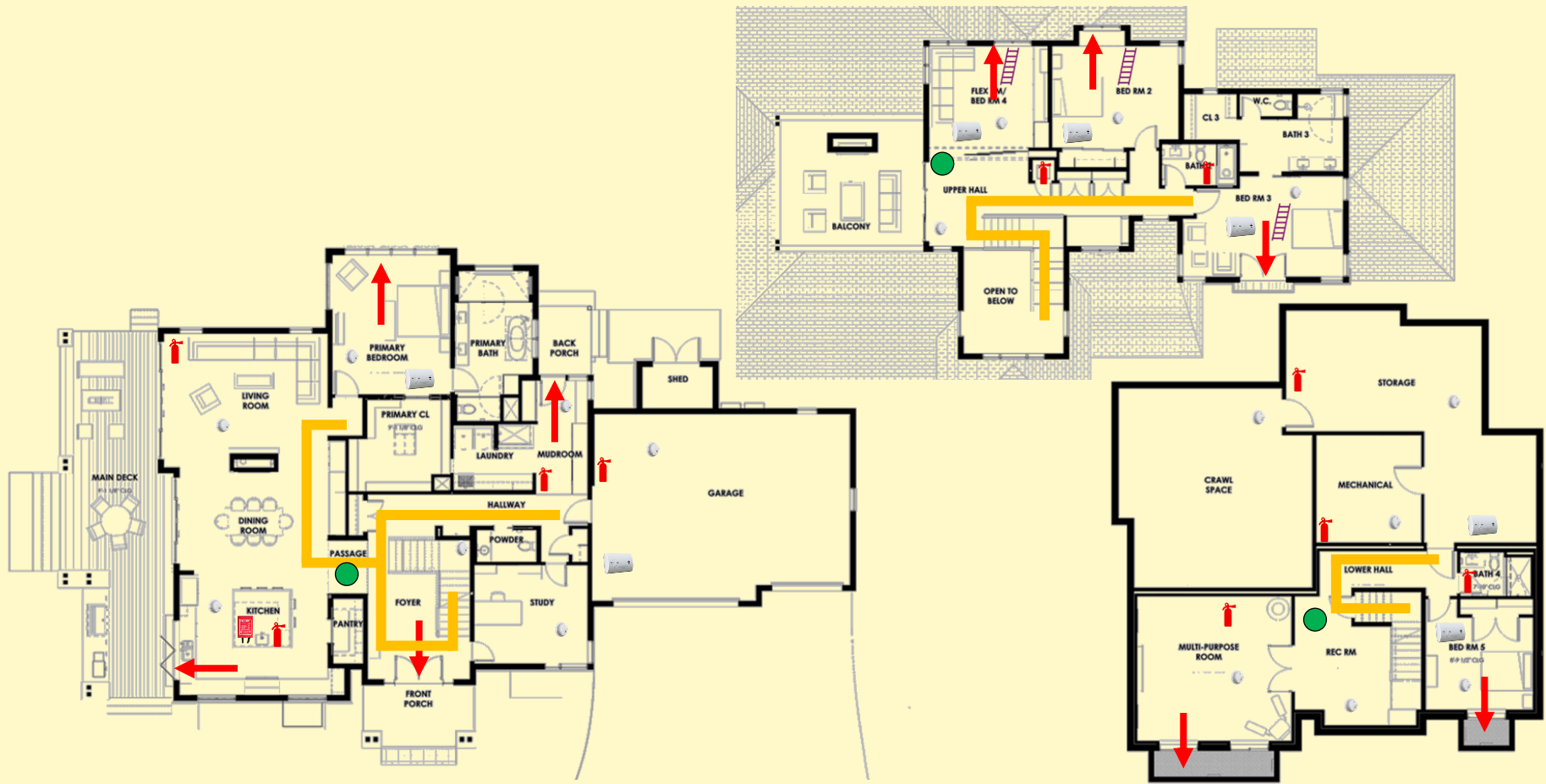
Dad	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Mom	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 11	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 9	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 6	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window

**STEP
4C**

Shelter (Shelter)

Ensure survivability for time it takes first responders to arrive and signal location for quick extraction.

Dad	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Mom	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 11	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 9	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window
Age 6	1) shut door 2) open window 3) grab whistle 4) place 1 green dot per person on window



STEP
5A

Rally Point (Exit)

Ensure external accountability at external rally point.

Dad	Head straight to 2324 mailbox. Get accountability. Walk external of house and note all green dots.
Mom	Head straight to 2324 mailbox. Get accountability. Walk external of house and note all green dots.
Age 11	Head straight to 2324 mailbox. Get accountability. Walk external of house and note all green dots.
Age 9	Head straight to 2324 mailbox. Get accountability. Walk external of house and note all green dots.
Age 6	Head straight to 2324 mailbox. Get accountability. Walk external of house and note all green dots.

STEP
5B

Rally Point (Collapse)

Ensure external accountability at external rally point.

Dad	N/A
Mom	N/A
Age 11	N/A
Age 9	N/A
Age 6	N/A

**STEP
5C**

Rally Point (Shelter)

Ensure external accountability at external rally point.

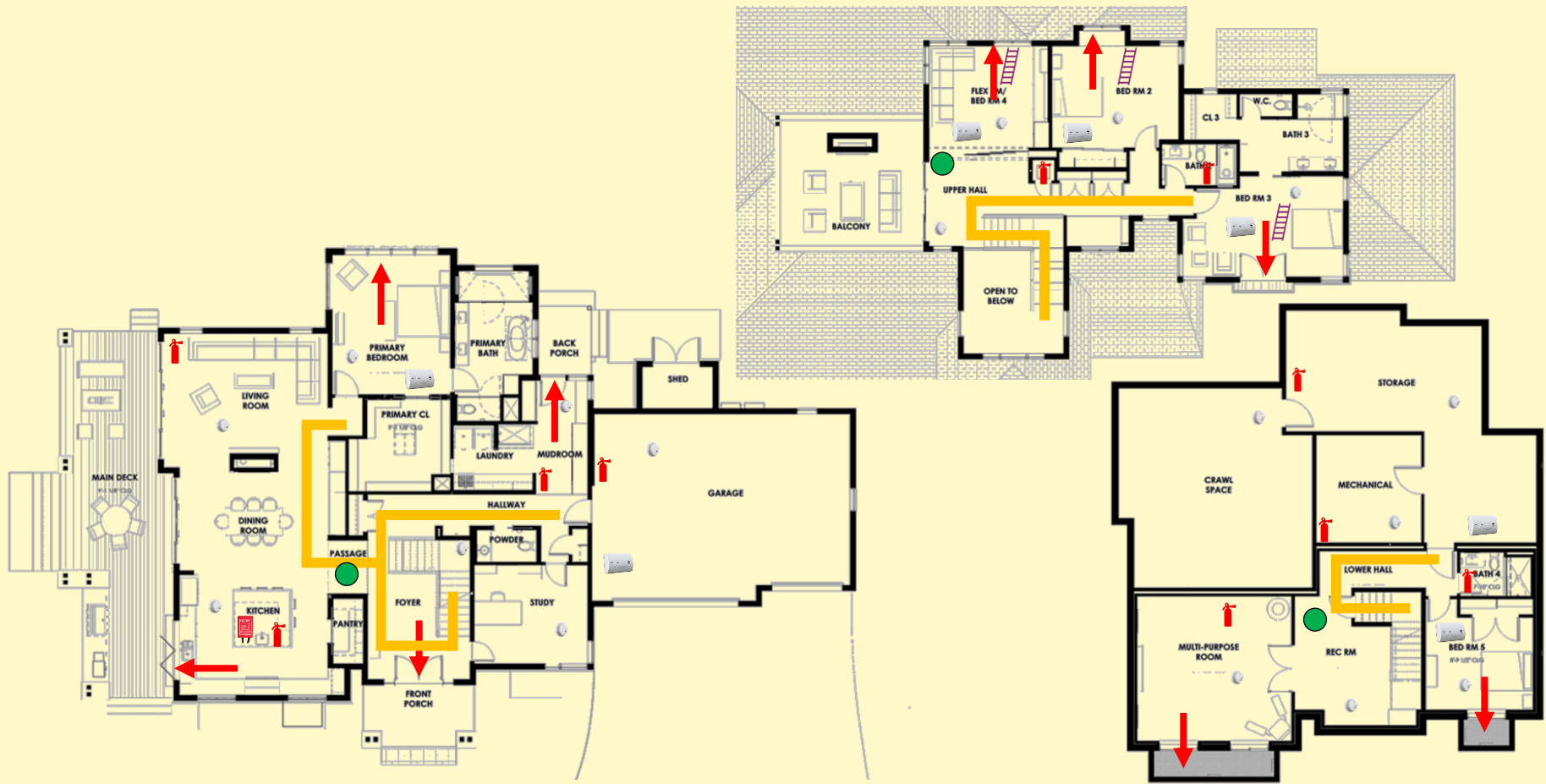
Dad N/A

Mom N/A

Age 11 N/A

Age 9 N/A

Age 6 N/A



STEP
6A

First Responder (Exit)

External extraction if possible and prepare fire fighters for expeditious extraction.

Dad	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations. Use external ladder if available.
Mom	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations. Use external ladder if available.
Age 11	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.
Age 9	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.
Age 6	Call 911. Give firefighters dot locations.

STEP
6B

First Responder (Collapse)

Prepare fire fighters for expeditious extraction.

Dad	N/A
Mom	N/A
Age 11	N/A
Age 9	N/A
Age 6	N/A

**STEP
6C**

First Responder (Shelter)

Prepare fire fighters for expeditious extraction.

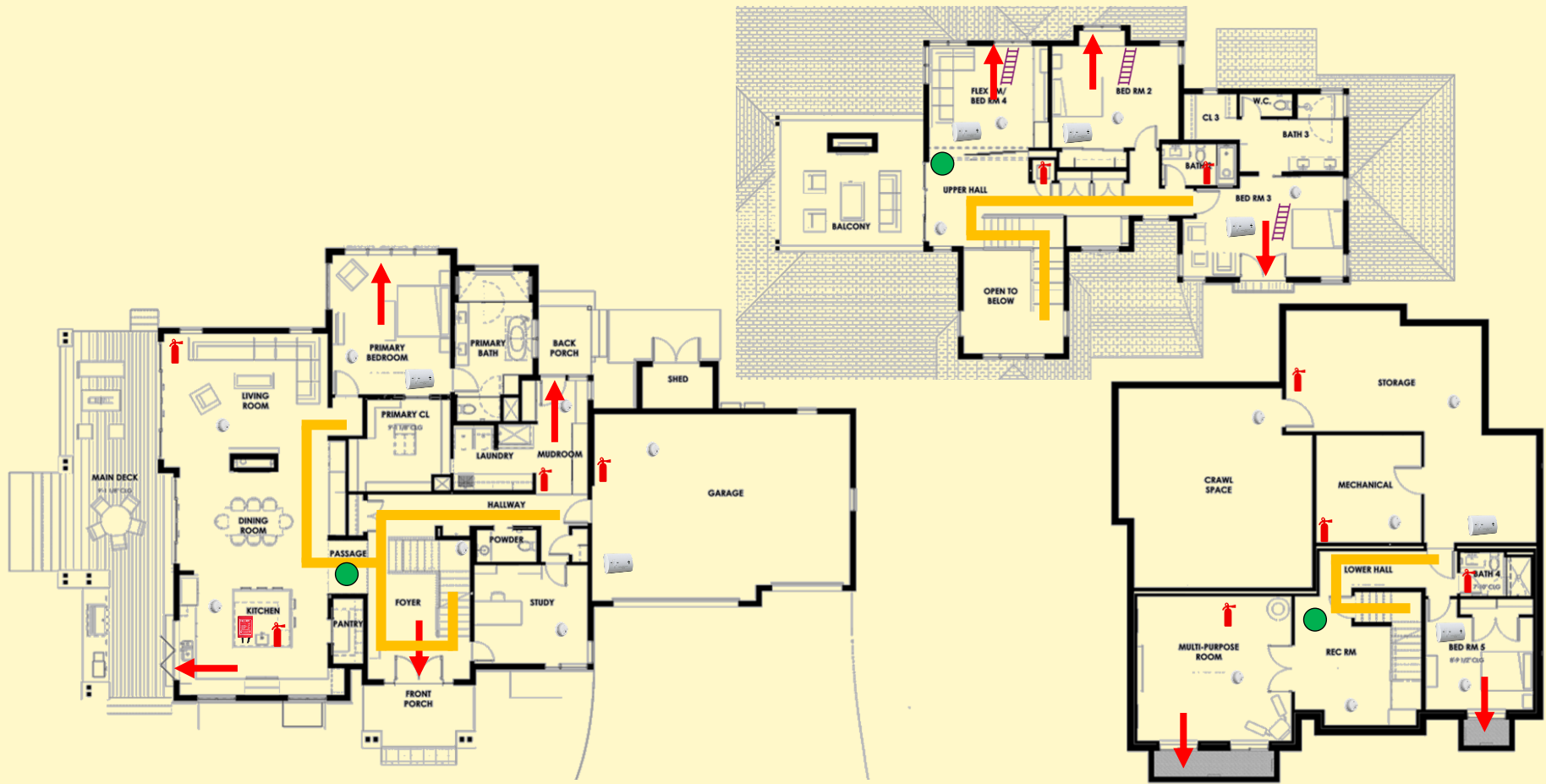
Dad N/A

Mom N/A

Age 11 N/A

Age 9 N/A

Age 6 N/A



8.0 Required Equipment

Equipment	Specifications	Maintenance	Life Span	Location	Date Inspected
Green Self-Adhesive Light	4 hrs illumination; nontoxic, nonflammable, waterproof	Inspect adhesive backing annually; replace if peeling	4 years	Each assigned green-dot rally point, every floor (1 per dot)	
Survival Whistle	Pealess design; 120 dB, audible up to 1 mile	Test annually; clean mouthpiece	Indefinite; replace if cracked	Each family member's bedroom (1 per person, 5 total)	
Fire Blanket (40" x 40")	Fiberglass, fire-retardant; no expiration date	Inspect seal annually; replace after any use	Single-use	Kitchen, mounted near stove (1 total)	
Fire Ladder	2-story, tension-mounted; supports 1,000+ lbs	Inspect hooks/rungs annually; verify window-anchor fit	10 years or per manufacturer rating	Each 2nd-floor bedroom without ground-level exit (1 per room, 3 total)	
Smoke Alarm	Dual-sensor (photoelectric + ionization); sealed 10-yr battery	Test monthly; vacuum vents every 6 months	10 years from manufacture date	Every bedroom, hallway, and level (7 total, Section 2)	
Carbon Monoxide Detector (CO)	Electrochemical sensor; digital ppm display recommended	Test monthly; replace per sensor life	5–7 years (sensor degradation)	Utility room; outside sleeping areas (1 installed; confirm full coverage)	

9.0 First Responder Sheet



The First Responder 1 Pager is a single sheet you hand directly to firefighters or police when they arrive at your home, giving them instant situational awareness without you having to communicate under stress.

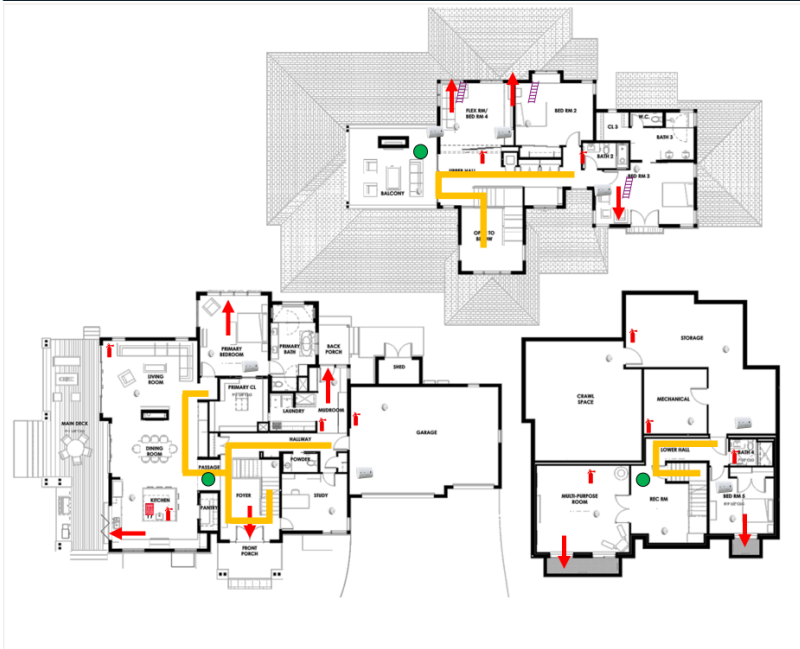
It tells them who's in the house, where they sleep, any medical conditions to know about, where hazards like firearms and gas shutoffs are located, and how to read the floor plan.

SAFE STEPS

FIRST RESPONDER
1 PAGER

472 Cville Drive
Charlottesville, VA 22911

FLOOR PLAN



 Accessible Window

 Internal Rally Point

 Internal Accountability Route

 Fire Extinguisher

OCCUPANTS

#	NAME	ROLE	AGE	HT.	MEDICAL / CONDITIONS
1	SARAH	Mother	40	5'4"	None
2	MICHAEL	Father	39	6'1"	None
3	JOEY	Child	11	4'10"	None
4	JAMES	Child	9	4'0"	+ Asthma — inhaler Bed. 2
5	MICHELE	Child	6	3'7"	+ Penicillin allergy
6	OLIVER	Dog	—	—	—
6	WHISKERS	Cat	—	—	—

RALLY POINT & CONTACTS

Primary Rally Point
Neighbor mailbox across street
473 Cville Drive

Sarah's parents 123-456-7890

Michael's parents 987-654-3210

Local friend 192-837-4650

Hazard notes

2 firearms — master suite first floor · Natural gas — shutoff at meter

SAFESTEPSPLANS.COM · VETERAN-FOUNDED & OPERATED

Last updated: September 2025

10.0 Rehearsal Protocol



A plan that has never been rehearsed is a hypothesis. Rehearsal is what turns this document into muscle memory — actions the family can execute under stress without stopping to think through each step. This section covers how often to rehearse, how to run a rehearsal that actually tests the plan, how to score it honestly, and how to use the three tools built to support all three.

Tier	Proficiency Represented	Yellow Brick Road	Alamo	Advance	Regress
Weekly	Initial — the plan is not yet internalized	5 of 13 pts	7 of 17 pts	3 consecutive	Floor tier — no fallback
Monthly	Intermediate — the plan is mostly internalized	9 of 13 pts	13 of 17 pts	3 consecutive	2 consecutive misses
Quarterly	Sustained — the plan is fully internalized	13 of 13 pts	17 of 17 pts	Maintain	2 consecutive misses

Rehearsal frequency is a function of demonstrated proficiency, not elapsed time. A household advances to a less frequent tier only after satisfying the benchmark for its current tier in three consecutive iterations, and returns to the next more frequent tier after two consecutive iterations below benchmark.

THREE TOOLS THAT SUPPORT REHEARSAL

1 SCENARIO GENERATOR

Randomly places the fire and randomly assigns every family member a starting position on the household's actual floor plan, so no two rehearsals begin the same way.

2 DIGITAL SCORE CARD

The same objectives as the paper Score Card, scored live on a phone or tablet. Totals the score and percentage automatically.

3 SCORE HISTORY

Every logged drill, plotted over time, so the household can determine whether performance is actually improving before advancing a tier.

All three are available in the Rehearsal Aids tab of the family portal.

**STEP
1****SET THE SCENARIO**

Open Rehearsal Aids → Scenario Generator in the portal. Enter how many people are home for this drill and tap Generate Scenario. The tool randomly places the fire and randomly assigns each person's starting position on your actual floor plan, so the family never rehearses the identical scenario twice.

**STEP
2****BRIEF POSITIONS, NOT ANSWERS**

Tell each person their assigned starting room. Do not tell anyone where the fire is. Discovering it, and reacting correctly to what they find from their assigned position, is the entire point of the drill.

**STEP
3****RUN IT LIVE, ON THE CLOCK**

Start a timer the moment the drill begins. Execute the plan exactly as written from each person's assigned position — Alert, Assess, Accountability, Movement, Rally Point, First Responder — as a real event, not a walkthrough.

**STEP
4****SCORE IT IMMEDIATELY AFTER**

While it is fresh, gather the family and go through the Score Card together. Mark each objective Yes or No exactly as it happened, not as it was supposed to happen.

**STEP
5****LOG THE RESULT**

Enter the score in the portal's New Drill tool, or transcribe the paper card. This saves it to Score History, where the trend across drills, not any single drill, is what determines readiness to advance a tier.

Each objective on the Score Card describes a single, observable action. Scoring is not a matter of judgment or impression: the action either occurred as described, or it did not.

A BINARY SCORING STANDARD	Each objective is scored as a binary outcome; approximate or partial execution does not satisfy the objective. This standard is intentional — the purpose of strict scoring is to surface procedural gaps before an actual fire does.
THE ACCOUNTABILITY LEAD SCORES	An independent, non-participating observer is rarely available, since every adult in the household is ordinarily assigned a role in the drill itself. The adult designated for the Accountability step is best positioned to also score the rehearsal, as this role already requires confirming the location and status of every occupant.
SCORING OCCURS DURING THE DEBRIEF	Recollection of specific actions degrades quickly once a drill has ended. Objectives should be scored during the debrief immediately following the rehearsal, rather than reconstructed afterward from memory.
TWO METHODS OF RECORDING, NEITHER LIVE	The printed Score Card included in this plan may be completed manually, with affirmative responses tallied by hand during the debrief. Alternatively, the New Drill tool in the family portal performs the same function digitally, calculating the total score and percentage automatically and recording it to Score History. Neither method is intended for use during the drill itself: recording results live, while the rehearsal is still in progress, diverts attention from observation and undermines the debrief-based scoring standard established above.

A rehearsal's score is its total count of affirmative responses. This total is evaluated against the benchmark for the household's current tier (Section A) to determine whether the iteration counts toward advancement.

A single score — good or bad — does not tell you much on its own. Assess rehearsal quality across drills, not within one.

ONE GOOD SCORE ISN'T READINESS

The plan requires two consecutive iterations at or above the benchmark before advancing a tier. A single strong drill can be luck, an easy scenario, or a fresh memory of this plan — not yet proof of habit.

ONE LOW SCORE ISN'T REGRESSION

Repeat the drill at the current tier. Look at which specific objectives failed — the Score Card tells you exactly where the plan broke down, not just that it did.

WATCH THE TREND, NOT THE POINT

Open Score History in the portal after every drill. A flat or rising trend near the benchmark means the current tier is calibrated correctly. A drop shortly after advancing a tier is an early signal the family moved too fast — consider stepping back down.

SPEED COUNTS AS MUCH AS ACCURACY

Every rehearsal is timed. A perfect Score Card completed too slowly is not a good rehearsal — the plan exists because the survivable window in this home is measured in minutes. Track time alongside score in Score History.

Yellow Brick Road Score Card

Step	Question	Success?
1 — Alert	1) The cue "Yellow Brick Road" was called immediately by whoever first spotted smoke or flame	
1 — Alert	2) Every occupant relayed the cue without waiting to be told	
2 — Assess	3) Adults evaluated whether the fire could safely be fought before escalating	
2 — Assess	4) Any doubt resulted in an immediate move to step 3	
2 — Assess	5) Children moved to the nearest green dot on their floor without adult direction	
3 — Accountability	6) Dad ran the full Yellow Brick Road and confirmed the location of every person	
3 — Accountability	7) Dad directed each person to their nearest exit before moving on	
4 — Movement	8) Every occupant exited through the door Dad directed them to	
4 — Movement	9) No one stopped to grab belongings or deviated from the directed route	
5 — Rally point	10) All occupants went directly to the mailbox after exiting	
5 — Rally point	11) No one re-entered the house once at the rally point	
6 — First responder	12) 911 was called within 3 minutes of the trigger	
6 — First responder	13) The emergency response sheet was located and ready to hand to firefighters	

Alamo Score Card		
Step	Question	Success?
1 — Alert	1) "Alamo" was called immediately when smoke or flame was identified as blocking movement	
1 — Alert	2) All occupants stopped and assessed their own situation rather than moving automatically	
2 — Assess	3) Every occupant checked their door with the back of their hand before opening it	
2 — Assess	4) Every occupant checked for smoke along the door seam	
2 — Assess	5) Each occupant correctly identified their branch based on their door check result alone	
3 — Movement (Exit)	6) Anyone whose door check was clear moved to their closest exit and went directly to the mailbox	
3 — Movement (Collapse)	7) Children moved to Lucas's room; adults stayed in their own rooms	
3 — Movement (Shelter)	8) Anyone whose door showed heat or smoke stayed in their room and did not attempt to move through the hazard	
4 — Shelter actions	9) Every sheltering occupant shut their door and opened their window	
4 — Shelter actions	10) Every sheltering occupant grabbed their whistle	
4 — Shelter actions	11) The correct number of green dots was placed on the window — one per person, visible from outside	
5 — Rally point	12) Anyone who exited reached the mailbox and established accountability	
5 — Rally point	13) No one who got out re-entered the building	
5 — Rally point	14) Someone walked the exterior and noted the location and count of all green dots in windows	
6 — First responder	15) 911 was called within 3 minutes	
6 — First responder	16) Green dot locations — floor, room, and count — were relayed to the dispatcher	
6 — First responder	17) Firefighters were met at the rally point and briefed on dot locations before entry	

11.0 911 Script



This script is not intended to be located and read aloud during an actual call; doing so remains an acceptable fallback if needed, but is not its purpose. Its function is rehearsal: repeated practice with this script builds familiarity with the structure and pace of a 911 call in advance, so that an actual call draws on practiced recall rather than an unfamiliar document read for the first time under stress.

If prompted for answers from the dispatcher, answer the questions first, then continue with the script.

Line	Sentence
Line 1	There is a fire at my home. The address is 472 Cville Drive. My name is [name].
Line 2	The fire is located in [room/area/floor]. It [is/is not] spreading.
Line 3 (everyone out of house)	All 5 family members are out of the house. We are located at the mailbox for 473 Cville Drive.
Line 3 (people trapped inside)	[#] people are trapped in the house. Their ages are [ages], their locations are marked by glowing green lights on windows.
Line 4	We [do/do not] have injuries.
Line 5	The home has [natural gas/firearms/other hazards] located [location].

12.0 Command & Signal



This card consolidates the plan's command and communication structure into a single reference: who directs the response if a parent is not present, how to reach emergency contacts, and the verbal, visual, and audible signals this plan uses to communicate condition and location without ambiguity.

Item	Details
Rally Point	Mailbox at 473 Cville Drive
Succession of Command	If Dad is not present, Mom assumes the Accountability Lead role. If neither parent is present, the supervising adult directs children to the nearest exit and calls 911.
Primary Neighbor for 911 Call	The Andersons at 473 Cville Drive
Alternate Neighbor for 911 Call	The Smiths at 475 Cville Drive
Local Emergency Contact	Rebecca Johnson, Friend, 192-837-4650
Secondary Local Contact	Jim Reynolds, Neighbor, 123-456-7892
Primary Family Emergency Contact	Dana Williams, Sarah's Mother, 123-456-7890
Secondary Family Emergency Contact	Kara Williams, Sarah's Sister, 123-456-7891
Proword — Yellow Brick Road	Smoke/Fire NOT Blocking Movement
Proword — Alamo	Smoke/Fire Blocking Movement
Signal — Green Dot / Green Light	Internal rally point; go to the nearest marker and wait there
Signal — Whistle	Sound continuously to indicate your location if trapped or sheltering in place
Utility Shutoff — Gas	Left side of house, back side of deck
Utility Shutoff — Electrical	Basement, mechanical room

13.0 Post Fire Insurance Documentation



The household's financial recovery depends on actions taken in the days immediately following a fire, before evidence is altered and before claim deadlines begin to run. The following steps are grouped by when they matter most: immediate actions, building the claim, and protecting the household's interests through the process.

13.1 Immediate Actions

- 1 Call Your Insurer Immediately**
Contact the 24/7 claims line with your policy number to start the clock and unlock ALE coverage.
- 2 Secure the Property from Further Damage**
Board broken windows and tarp roof damage. Most policies require reasonable steps to prevent additional loss.
- 3 Document Before Anything Is Touched**
Photograph and video all damage. Do not discard items until the adjuster visits.
- 4 Track Temporary Housing Expenses**
Keep every receipt for hotels, food, and essentials — ALE coverage reimburses these costs from day one.

13.2 Building the Claim

- 5 Notify Your Mortgage Lender**
Most loan agreements require this after major damage; claim checks are often issued jointly to homeowner and lender.
- 6 Get the Fire Department Report**
Request an official report documenting the fire's cause and extent as critical evidence.
- 7 Build a Detailed Inventory**
Record each item's description, brand, model, and replacement value room by room.
- 8 Know Your Coverage**
Understand dwelling, personal property, ALE, and deductible coverage types in your policy.

13.3 Protecting Your Interests

- 9 Put Everything in Writing**
Copy all adjuster documents and get repair permissions in writing.
- 10 You Can Dispute the Estimate**
Get independent estimates and consider hiring a public adjuster to negotiate.

14.0 Plan Maintenance & Communication



A household plan remains accurate only insofar as it reflects the household's current composition, structure, and support network. Two distinct processes preserve this accuracy: maintenance, which revises the plan's content, and communication, which extends awareness of the existing plan to individuals who did not previously require it.

MAINTENANCE — Revise the Plan When:

- 1 A child is born or adopted into the household**
The new occupant requires an assigned sleeping location, escape route, and self-rescue capability rating (Section 3).
- 2 An elderly parent or dependent relocates into the household**
The new occupant likely requires a revised self-rescue assumption and, where applicable, an assigned assist role.
- 3 The household relocates to a different residence**
Structure, egress points, and rally point are specific to the property; none carry over to a new address.
- 4 Renovation alters egress, stairwells, or room use**
Any change to a documented escape route invalidates the corresponding objective on the Score Card.
- 5 A household member's mobility or medical status changes materially**
Self-rescue capability (Section 3) is a structural assumption of the plan, not a fixed trait.

COMMUNICATION — Brief Additional People When:

- 1 A relative or guest stays with the household for an extended period**
Extended presence, not a fixed duration, is the operative test; a stay of a week or more warrants a briefing.
- 2 A nanny or au pair assumes regular supervisory responsibility**
A caregiver present during the household's ordinary risk hours (Section 5) requires the same briefing as a resident adult.
- 3 A relative or neighbor regularly supervises children after school**
Recurring, scheduled supervision constitutes a standing responsibility, not an occasional favor.
- 4 A child hosts an overnight guest**
A visiting child is an unplanned occupant for the duration of the stay and should be briefed on exit and rally point assignment at minimum.

Maintenance revises what the plan states; communication extends who is positioned to execute it. A household should treat both as standing procedures triggered by circumstance, not as tasks completed once at the plan's creation.